NEWS

Prosecutor: Gunman turned Plymouth into ‘O.K. Corral’



Mark Moran / The Citizens’ Voice William Allabaugh is led to his preliminary hearing in Nanticoke on Friday morning.

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By **BOB KALINOWSKI** | bkalinowski@citizensvoice.com | The Citizens' Voice

PUBLISHED: November 30, 2012 at 7:00 AM EST | UPDATED: November 30, 2012 at 12:00 PM EST

NANTICOKE – The prosecutor likened the scene to the legendary Wild West gunfight at the O.K. Corral with William Allabaugh as the outlaw.

A man blasted off his bar stool by a gunshot to the head. A fleeing patron fatally gunned down on Main Street. The shooter firing indiscriminately at bystanders until one of them returned fire to end the rampage.

But instead of Tombstone, Ariz., in 1881, this was Main Street, Plymouth, the early morning hours of Sept. 9, eyewitnesses recalled Friday.

Allabaugh, of Plymouth, appeared in court yesterday for a preliminary hearing connected to an alleged shooting rampage that began inside Bonnie's Food and Spirits and spilled into the street. The 25-year-old is accused of shooting Stephen Hollman, 29, in the head inside the bar just before 2 a.m. on Sept. 9 and then fatally shooting Scott Luzetsky, 39, outside the 133 E. Main St. tavern.

"It was his intent to commit murder," Luzerne County Assistant District Attorney Jarrett Ferentino said. "These individuals didn't provoke the defendant. They didn't antagonize the defendant. They didn't fight with the defendant. The defendant knowingly, willingly and intentionally turned Main Street in Plymouth into the O.K. Corral and got into a gunfight in the middle of the street."

After about 90 minutes of dramatic testimony, Magisterial District Judge Donald Whittaker forwarded an open count of criminal homicide and a charge of attempted murder against Allabaugh to Luzerne County Court for trial.

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Another bar patron, Mark Ktytor, 35, of Plymouth, is credited with stopping the rampage by shooting Allabaugh multiple times upon being confronted on Main Street. Ktytor wasn't subpoenaed to testify Friday, but prosecutors said he would be available for trial.

Bar employee Bob Wallace said Allabaugh snapped when he told Allabaugh he had to leave because patrons complained he was armed.

"I saw him reaching, then he pulled a gun and fired a shot" at Hollman, Wallace said.

Hollman, who was chatting on a cellphone and sipping a soda, was shot in the back of the head and remains in critical condition in a medical facility in Hamburg, Berks County, authorities said.

Immediately prior to the shot, Allabaugh, who is white, was sitting to the left of and chatting with two black women who were with Hollman, who is also black, police said. At the time of Allabaugh's arrest, police said Allabaugh was warned earlier in the night he would be kicked out for making racial slurs, but that was prior to Hollman arriving at the bar. The issue wasn't mentioned Friday.

After Hollman was shot, Wallace said he and Ktytor followed Allabaugh outside. He said he spotted Allabaugh up the street walking away, but then Allabaugh turned around when Ktytor said, "There he is."

"He took his gun and pointed it at us, shooting," Wallace recalled.

"We're talking about Main Street, Plymouth?" Ferentino asked.

"Main Street, Plymouth," Wallace responded.

Allabaugh kept coming toward them firing, Wallace said, noting he and Ktytor ducked for cover behind parked cars.

"Obviously, he was trying to kill us, in my eyes," Wallace said.

At some point, Luzetsky exited the bar, apparently seeking to flee the barroom chaos and walk a few blocks home. Wallace said he saw Luzetsky

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As Wallace and Ktytor took cover behind a car, Wallace said he saw Ktytor reach for something.

“I said, ‘Mark, you got a gun?’ He said, ‘Yes.’ I said, ‘Do you have a license?’ He said, ‘Yeah.’ I said, ‘You gotta do what you gotta do. He’s shooting at us,’” Wallace recalled.

Wallace said Ktytor twice warned Allabaugh “I got a gun” before firing and dropping Allabaugh to the ground.

Ktytor and Allabaugh possessed county-issued concealed carry permits, police have said. Prosecutors said Friday that Ktytor was justified in his actions.

At the conclusion of testimony, Allabaugh’s attorneys asked Whittaker to drop first-degree murder charges, arguing prosecutors didn’t establish Allabaugh’s intent. Ferentino argued Allabaugh intended to kill by pointing a deadly weapon at two innocent people and firing multiple gunshots.

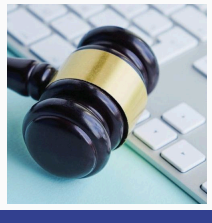
Whittaker ordered Allabaugh to stand trial on all charges in Luzerne County Court.

After the hearing, Allabaugh was remanded to the Luzerne Count Correctional Facility without bail.

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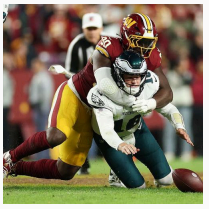
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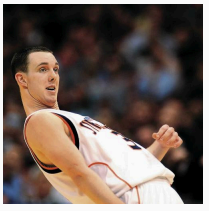
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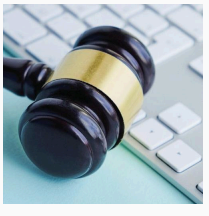
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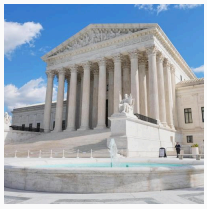


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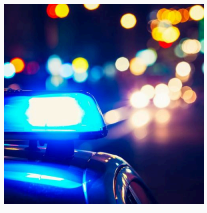
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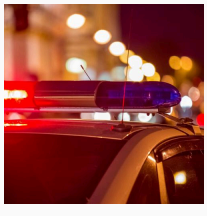
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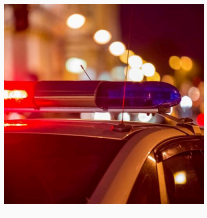
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